



THE REAL TIMES

Real News in Real Time



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Kafwaya is dead

....Family positively identifies Mutotwe Kafwaya as one shot dead at Mundubile's residence

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The late Mutotwe Kafwaya

Youth Fund on cards

By Alex Maboshe

President-elect Hakainde Hichilema has announced plans to introduce a special cash fund for Zambia's youth.

Addressing a large gathering of UPND supporters at the Community House in Lusaka today, Mr Hichilema said the programme would serve as a token of appreciation to young people for their role in re-electing him to the presidency.

He encouraged the youth to use the funds to launch small businesses and as seed capital to pursue their goals.

He said the to-be introduced youth fund will be budgeted for separately and not be under the Citizens Economic Empowerment Commission (CEEC).

Mr Hichilema said his government will continue delivering on reforms that have already taken off like free education which was signed into law this year by him.

"Free education is now law, meaning that no one will remove it, so do not worry about your children's education, go and have 10 children if you want," he joke to a loud euphoria of laughter and cheer.

Mr Hichilema also reaffirmed his commitment to protecting the people of Zambia and maintaining peace.

He stressed that he would not tolerate any threats to the country and extended gratitude to the security forces for their work during the general elections.

Chester, others still held in Mongu

By Ruth Kambita

Three artists, among them musicians Moses Ng'andwe, popularly known as Chester Mo-Power, Felix Mangani Phiri, widely known as Felix Ndangeni Inshila, and comedian Winston Ngosa, also known as IDC Light Comedy, with 17 others expected to appear before the courts tomorrow after their arrest on August 5, 2026.

The suspects are facing

riotous behaviour charges.

According to their lawyer, Wisdom Nyirenda police had not yet opened dockets for the suspects when he took over the matter on August 9, despite them already being detained. He also said the suspects were arrested in Kalabo, but the dockets indicate that they were picked up in Mongu.

The lawyer said the group is accused of stoning a police vehicle during the incident that led to their arrest.

The suspects remain in custody in Mongu District.

Filmmaker Cosmas Ng'andwe, who visited the 17 suspects in Mongu, called on fellow artists to support their colleagues while allowing the law to take its course.

Earlier today, Zambia Association of Musicians president Brian Bwembya commonly known as B Flow said Chester, IDC Light Comedy and Felix Ndangeni Inshila have been given legal representation.

14 held in Kitwe unrest

By Ruth Kambita

Fourteen men are in police custody after a violent row over control of Oxford Bus Station, also known as Savage Yard Bus Station, spilled into the streets and disrupted business in Kitwe's central business district today.

Copperbelt Police Commanding Officer Rae Hamoonga

said officers were alerted at about 11:30 hours after a faction of taxi drivers allegedly tried to take over management of the station.

He said the move angered other drivers, leading to clashes that forced business activities in the CBD to grind to a halt.

The suspects are being held pending further investigations and possible prosecution.

Mr Hamoonga warned members of the public against taking the law into their own hands, saying the police would not allow chaos, violence or destruction of property to go unchecked.

He said offenders would be dealt with firmly in accordance with the law, regardless of political affiliation, status or position.

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Fulfill campaign promises, Govt urged

By Luyando Mukuka

The Small-Scale Miners Association of Zambia has called on government to translate

campaign promises into concrete action to improve the livelihoods of miners.

Association Chairperson Kelvin Tembo says small-scale mining remains a critical

source of livelihood for many young people, particularly on the Copperbelt, where formal employment opportunities remain limited compared to the growing youth population.

Mr. Tembo says many youths have turned to mining because it is one of the few economic activities readily available in their communities.

He says declarations made during the election campaigns have given artisanal and small-scale miners renewed hope following President Hakainde Hichilema's re-election.

Mr. Tembo says the association is encouraged by efforts already underway but wants government to ensure that promises made to the sector are implemented.

"All is to see that they are fulfilled and they are brought to fruition. As you may be aware, this is livelihood. As I've often said, these artisanal and small-scale miners really

just depend on this for their survival," he said.

He says there is growing anticipation among miners, adding that government must now move from political pronouncements to practical measures that will empower artisanal and small-scale miners and improve their economic standing.

EU Observers raise 2026 election concern

By Ruth Kambita

The European Union Election Observation Mission (EU EOM) has reported what it describes as a deterioration in Zambia's election results tabulation process following the Electoral Commission of Zambia's (ECZ) suspension of counting on August 14.

Tabulation was conducted in 226 constituency-level totalling centres, with the process still continuing in some centres. The ECZ halted the counting and announcement of results nationwide between 12:00 and 18:00, citing violent incidents targeting polling staff and allegations of ballot-box theft.

The EU EOM monitored proceedings in 64 totalling centres and said the process had been assessed as "very

good" in 43 per cent of its observations before the suspension. Polling agents and citizen observers were present in almost all the centres observed and followed the entry of results.

However, after counting resumed, the mission said the overall conduct of tabulation declined considerably. In many centres, officials failed to record results on tally sheets immediately after they were announced by returning officers, as required by electoral regulations.

The mission also reported a decline in the number of cases where figures entered into digital results management kits corresponded with those on tally sheets. Transparency was assessed as "bad" or "very bad" in 12 percent of centres observed after the suspension, while only 27 per cent were rated "very good."

Extended breaks were reported in 42 per cent of observations, with returning officers appearing to wait for instructions from ECZ headquarters before announcing results.

The EU EOM further said a heavy military presence at totalling centres intimidated stakeholders and contributed to fewer party agents and citizen observers attending the proceedings.

The mission also received reports of violence in Lusaka and Central Province, including an attack on the Makeni totalling centre and alleged raids at two centres in Kabwe.

The EU EOM has urged the ECZ to publish disaggregated results by polling station to strengthen transparency and public confidence. It remains in Zambia observing the process across all 10 provinces.

ERB recovers K400,000 from 9 defaulters

By Ruth Kambita

The Energy Regulation Board (ERB) has recovered K417,851.60 from nine energy-sector licensees after enforcement action over breaches of licence conditions and regulatory directives, underscoring the regulator's drive to strengthen compliance and protect consumers.

ERB Manager Public Relations Namukolo Kasumpa said five companies paid outstanding statutory and regulatory fees following debt-collection measures.

Onsite Energy Limited settled K104,985.80, Ordod Oil Company Limited K92,299.70, Xtra Energies Limited K43,000.15 (for Fuel Marking and Strategic Reserve Fund fees), Afrivert Energy Limited K35,451.43 and

Asharami Energy Resource Limited K14,200.00.

"Compliance with licence conditions, statutory obligations and directives issued are fundamental requirements for all licensed entities operating in the energy sector," Mrs Kasumpa said, adding the ERB would continue to take action against defaulters to safeguard standards and consumers.

Separately, three companies, Lake Energies Zambia Limited, Mount Meru Petroleum Zambia Limited and Puma Energy Zambia Limited — were reprimanded after inspections found non-functional compressed

air systems, a breach of Clause 3.3.1 of their licence conditions.

Zhong Kuang Services Company Limited was fined K60,000 for failing to comply with an ERB directive of August 6, 2025, that required prioritising supply uplifts from the Ndola Fuel Terminal for the retail market; the company has paid the compounded penalty.

Mrs Kasumpa said the enforcement measures aimed to ensure a safe, reliable and efficient energy sector that supports the wider economy and protects consumers from service and safety lapses.

Kamwala makeshift structures reduced to ashes

By Alex Maboshe

More than 20 makeshift trading structures have been destroyed after fire broke out at the Kamwala Trading Area in Lusaka last evening.

Police Spokesperson Godfrey Chilabi confirmed that the incident occurred behind Downtown Shopping Mall along the railway line at around 20:40 hours.

He said the report was received through Kabwata police station and officers were immediately dispatched to the scene, where they found several temporary trading structures engulfed in flames.

Personnel from the Lusaka City Council Fire Brigade arrived promptly and successfully extinguished the blaze.

Preliminary investigations indicate that the fire may have started from a brazier that was

left burning at a makeshift restaurant.

An inquiry file has been opened, and police say investigations are continuing to determine the exact cause of the incident. No injuries were reported.

Authorities noted that the full extent of the damage and the value of the property destroyed have yet to be established and will be assessed in detail.

Mr. Chilabi urged traders operating from temporary structures to exercise extreme caution when using braziers and other sources of fire.

He advised traders to ensure that all open flames are completely extinguished before leaving their trading areas.

The police further called on the public to remain calm as investigations proceed.

‘We accept’

By Alex Maboshe

The National Reconciliation Party for Unity and Prosperity (NRPUP) has accepted the outcome of Zambia's presidential and general elections stating that it was not their time.

In a post-election statement issued today, the party's leadership noted the results announced by the Electoral Commission of Zambia (ECZ), which declared President Hichilema winner.

The party congratulated incumbent President Hakainde Hichilema on his victory.

NRPUP praised its own presidential candidate, Brian M. Mundubile, and running mate Mr. Makebi Zulu for what it described as a spirited campaign.

The party, which is less than three months old, highlighted its strong performance, saying it had emerged as the main opposition with more than 80 Members of Parliament, several council chairpersons and numerous councillors across the country describing

the achievement as huge.

The party also extended congratulations to its newly elected Members of Parliament, council chairpersons and councillors.

Looking ahead, NRPUP said the elections were now over and the time had come for national reconstruction.

The party pledged to occupy the official opposition space, offer checks and balances, and promote peaceful, democratic practices.

As the official opposition, it said it would work to ensure accountability and good governance.

In its conclusion, NRPUP urged all its members to refrain from any form of political violence.

"Democracy is about respecting the will of the people and sometimes it is not perfect. But that is the standard we have chosen to be governed by," the statement read.

"This was not our time. We accept the outcome and remain committed to serving

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‘Where are they?’

By Alex Maboshe

The Human Rights Commission has expressed concern over the ongoing detention of several individuals and the unresolved whereabouts of others following arrests and security operations linked to Zambia’s August 13, 2026, general elections.

Commission Chairperson Pamela Sambo said the body has been conducting investigations, visits, and spot checks at police stations across Lusaka, including Chelston, Matero, Lusaka Central, and Kabwata, to determine the location and conditions of those arrested.

The Commission confirmed that George Chisanga, Bishop Trevor Mwamba, and Patrick Mwansa remain in police custody.

As of Monday, August 17, the three had neither been charged nor brought before a competent court.

Ms Sambo also raised alarm over the continued uncertainty surrounding the whereabouts of former Transport and Logistics Minister Mutotwe Kafwaya.

The Commission has demanded that authorities disclose his location if he is in state custody and ensure he has access to his family and legal representatives.

In addition, the Commission is monitoring the detention of musician Chester and 16 other National Reconciliation Party for unity and prosperity (NRPUP) supporters in Mongu.

According to Preliminary inquiries, some may have been held beyond the legally prescribed period.

The Human Rights Commission has called on the Zambia Police Service and other law enforcement agencies to account for all persons whose whereabouts remain unknown.

It urged authorities to promptly charge detainees and present them before the courts, or release them where no lawful basis for continued detention exists.

The Commission further called for independent investigations into any alleged unlawful arrests, disappearances, detentions, or use of force during the post-election period, with those found responsible held accountable in accordance with the law.

Kafwaya is dead

By Alex Maboshe

Family members have identified a man shot dead during a joint security operation in Ka-

bulonga on Friday evening as former Transport and Logistics Minister Mutotwe Kafwaya. Inspector General of Police Grafle Musamba has revealed. Mr Musamba said this

evening that the Central Joint Operations Committee (CJOC), working with the Drug Enforcement Commission (DEC) and other security agencies, carried out an intelligence-led raid at a

named residence at about 19:30 on 14 August. He revealed that the operation followed leads obtained after a separate recovery of 7.3 million kwacha in Lusaka and months of monitoring

of individuals considered of national interest.

According to Mr Musamba, officers came under fire from unknown occupants when they arrived. The task force returned fire and recovered a firearm at the scene.

He said during the operation, one unidentified man was fatally wounded and taken to hospital, where he was pronounced dead on arrival.

“After recent social media reports of a missing person, investigators sought to establish whether the body matched the missing man. This evening Mr Kafwaya’s family attended and positively identified the deceased,” he said.

Eleven people were arrested at the premises, the statement said.

He said among the arrested, three are former special forces soldiers, described by officials as having specialised commando skills, sniper and marksman training, and experience with both small- and high-calibre weapons.

Mr Musamba said these individuals presented a potential national security risk because of their military training and alleged links to hostile groups.

Two retired police officers, one of whom served with the Flying Squad (CS), were also detained.

Authorities say investigations are ongoing and more information will be released in due course.

The CJOC added that those arrested are in custody while forensic and intelligence enquiries continue.

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Tree planting exercise in Mongu today in appreciation of President Hakainde Hichilema’s re-election in the 2026 General Elections. Pictures by Angela Lishungu /ZANIS

Mbala Mayor -Elect dies

By Alex Maboshe

The newly elected mayor of Mbala District, Steward Simutenda, has died in the early hours of today.

Mr Simutenda, who contested the mayoral election on the National Reconciliation Party for unity and prosperity (NRPUP) ticket, reportedly passed away after an illness.

He had been hospitalised about a week before Thursday’s elections after falling ill.

Despite his health challenges and his name already on the ballot, he went on to participate in the poll and was subsequently elected mayor of Mbala.

His death, coming less than a week after the election, has cut short what would have been his tenure in office.

Further details surrounding his death and funeral arrangements are expected to be announced by his family and relevant authorities.

The news has sent shockwaves through Mbala, with residents and political supporters expected to pay tribute to the late mayor-elect in the coming days.

File a petition, Mundubile told

By Luyando Mukuka

The Democratic Governance and Human Rights Advocates (DEGHA) has challenged Tonse Alliance presidential candidate Brian Mundubile to stop merely rejecting the 2026 presidential election results and instead file a formal peti-

tion if he is aggrieved.

DEGHA representative Gerald Mutelo says the Constitution provides a legal avenue for any person dissatisfied with an election outcome to challenge it, stressing that verbal rejection of the results is not enough.

Mr Mutelo says Mr Mundubile, who has rejected the

outcome of the presidential election, should use the courts to present any evidence of alleged irregularities rather than simply speaking against the results.

He says the law provides a seven-day period within which an aggrieved party can petition election results, explaining that the period is intended to

allow any legal challenge to be formally lodged.

“It’s not just speaking verbally, he has to file a petition,” Mr Mutelo says.

Mr Mutelo says if no petition is filed within the constitutional period, the President-elect can proceed to be sworn into office.

Mr Mundubile has ques-

tioned the credibility of the election and alleged possible interference and manipulation of the results. President Hakainde Hichilema was subsequently declared the winner with about 60 percent of the vote, while Mr Mundubile polled about 38 percent.

And Mr Mutelo says the constitutional process must now be allowed to take its course, with any grievances subjected to the appropriate legal mechanisms.

Zesco United Access new kits



The unveiling of the new Zesco kit in pictures. Pictures by Alex Maboshe

By Ruth Kambita

Access Bank Zambia has unveiled Zesco United's new playing kit underlining a partnership that has supported the Ndola club for nearly a decade.

Speaking at Access Bank Zambia House in Lusaka today, Access Bank Zambia Managing Director Iheanyi Nwogu said the jersey carries more than fabric and colours; it carries the club's identity, the pride of its supporters and the weight of expectation that comes with Zesco United's history.

"This is a Club that knows what it means to win: nine-time MTN Super League champions, seven-time ABSA Cup champions and nine appearances in the CAF Champions League," he said.

Nwogu who was represented by the Bank's Executive Director-Public Sector and Commercial Banking Helen Lunda, acknowledged a tougher campaign last season but urged the squad, popularly known as Team Ya Ziko, to reclaim its winning mentality.

"One difficult season does not erase the pedigree of a great club. My challenge to Team Ya Ziko today is to rediscover that winning mentality. Regain your position among the very best," he said, invoking Access Bank's motto for staff and partners, "unbowed, unbent, unbroken."

The new kits form part of Access Bank Zambia's K3 million sponsorship for the season, Nwogu added, stressing the deal is more than a logo on a shirt.

He said the Bank wants the support to help equip the team to compete and create value for the Club, its players and supporters adding that the partnership gives the bank a platform to connect with Zambian football fans nationwide.

Zesco United Board chairperson Patricia Musiya described the shirts as "a symbol of partnership, identity and belief in the future of Zesco United." Musiya said the funding and corporate backing allow the club to plan with greater confidence and to pursue success both on and off the pitch.

"We want to work with Access Bank not only to achieve success on the football pitch, but also to create a lasting impact away from it," she said.

The partnership, Musiya said, will be used for activities that benefit supporters, communities and youth development, while giving Access Bank visibility among one of Zambia's most passionate football followings.

Looking ahead to the 2026 Transitional League, Access Bank wished the team "good football, good health and, of course, many victories." Nwogu urged players to wear the shirt with pride and responsibility and for the technical team, leadership and fans to continue supporting the club's ambitions.

Team Ya Ziko now prepares to translate the symbolism of the new kit into results on the field as they chase a return to the summit of Zambian football.

Chilanga, Lusaka junior golfers shine on world stage

By Benedict Tembo

July was the month of experience, skill and exposure for teenage golfers from Chainama Hills Golf Club and Lusaka Golf Club.

Three juniors travelled beyond Africa to gain more experience in golf.

Leon Laviolette, 10, of Lusaka Golf Club travelled with his father, Marin, to France to play in the Grand Prix Jeunes de Valgarde which was sponsored by sports apparel firm, Lacoste.

Leon decided to play with Under-12 instead Under-10 to be able to play two times 18 holes (as the Under-10 was just one time nine holes).

So all kids were older than Léon and distances were longer.

Results

On the first day, Leon carded 84 gross and brought 81 gross on the second day to finish ninth out of 17 players in this category.

The total number of competitors in the Under-12 tournament was 50.

Marin was happy with his son's showing.

"Yes based on the fact he played on older category it is a good performance," he said.

Two Chilanga juniors, James Anscombe, eight years old and Maisha Maragia, 11, also travelled with their parents to Northern Ireland to play in the World Junior Champion of Champions.

With a total number of 250 juniors participating from all over the world, James and Maisha were amongst the top junior golfers battling it out in Northern Ireland.

The first day they played at Castle Hume Golf Club which was a reasonable course, and day two and



three, they played on the Nick Faldo Course.

James carded 45, 46 and 41 to finish 15th of 250 children under nine boys, playing the first round of nine holes on Castle Hume and rounds two and three on the iconic Nick Faldo course at Lough Erne, Enniskillen Northern Ireland.

Maisha on the other hand shot 94, 99 and 102 and finished 17th position in the Under-12 category Lusaka Golf Club said

they were proud of the performance of their juniors on the international stage and thanked their parents for believing in their children and investing in their future by supporting and financing their trips.

"The coaches can never go unnoticed as their skills are being put on display by the juniors," the club said.

Another nine Lusaka juniors are in South Africa where they are playing in the 2026 Junior Africa

Challenge in Durban, South Africa.

The Junior Africa Challenge Tournament, a three-day event is set for August 18 to 20, 2026, had confirmed 165 players from seven nations South Africa, hosting nation, Zambia, Botswana, Zimbabwe, Namibia, France and United States of America

The tournament is also a qualifying tournament for Ireland, Australia, Asia and the USA.

Kambani Lungu now FAZ General Manager

By Benedict Tembo

The Football Association of Zambia (FAZ) has appointed football administrator Kambani Lungu as General Manager for national teams.

Making the announcement in Lusaka yesterday, FAZ General Secretary Charles Chakatazaya said Colonel Lungu brings a wealth of football experience and knowledge to the national teams set-up, having served in various roles at club and association level.

Chakatazaya said the appointment is aimed at strengthening the coordination and administration of the national teams.

tion of the national teams.

"We are confident that Col. Lungu's experience in football administration will add value to the national teams set-up. His role will be critical in ensuring that our national teams are well coordinated and supported," Chakatazaya said.

In a statement by FAZ Head of Media and Communications Nkweto Tembwe, Chakatazaya said Col. Lungu was currently serving as Chief Executive Officer of MTN Super League side Red Arrows.

Before his appointment as Chief Executive Officer, Col. Lungu served as team manager at Arrows.

He has also previously served as a member of the Power Dynamos executive committee.

Chakatazaya said FAZ expects Col. Lungu to work closely with the technical and administrative teams at all levels to ensure smooth operations across all national teams.

"We welcome Col. Lungu to this important role and look forward to his contribution towards improving the management and development of our national teams," he said.

Col. Lungu takes over from Chakatazaya, who previously held the position before his recent appointment as FAZ General Secretary.